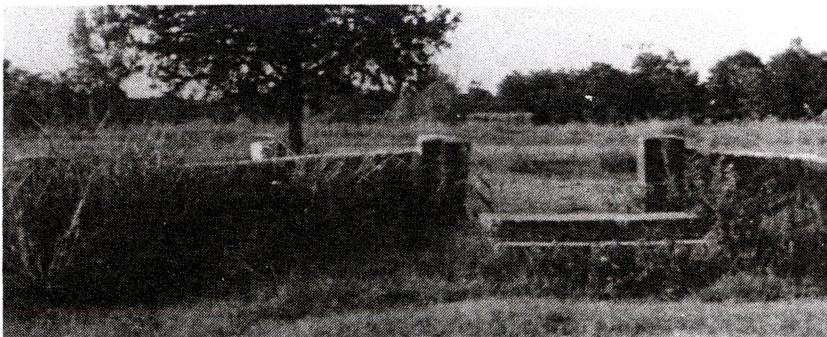




Vocational Building (Home Economics in left side, Agriculture in right side (east)).



View of Vocational Building after it was destroyed by a fire in 1986 (built by WPA).



View of a front entrance to Clearview School grounds. Originally the main school building was right behind the tree.

## TRANSPORTATION

Clearview had no major highway within its boundary. However, in 1903, the Fort Smith and Western Railroad crews were laying tracks west from Fort Smith, Arkansas toward Guthrie, Oklahoma. This railroad line passed through the Clearview townsite. The railroad company constructed a depot, employing a Black station agent. The depot consisted of a large waiting room for Blacks, a baggage freight room, a platform trolley, a ticket office combined with a small waiting room for whites, along with separate outdoor toilets. With four passenger trains and as many or more freight trains making daily runs through Clearview, transportation was not a big problem for getting in and out of Clearview.

The Fort Smith and Western Railroad employed a section foreman and crew (all Black) located in Clearview. This crew maintained the railroad bed approximately 4 miles East and 4 miles West of Clearview.

Ollie Walker Sr. served as section foreman perhaps longer than anyone else. Some of the crew members were Walter McBrayer, Simon Riley, Ed Castilow and Ed McBrayer, to mention a few.

Many times the section crew would be called out at night to repair tracks that were damaged by rockslides, washed out bridges, etc.

Fortunately there was only one major freight train derailment within the city limits - which occurred just one block north of Main Street. There were more than a dozen box cars dumped along the westside of the road bed. Several maintenance crews were brought in to restore the tracks for normal use. This operation took almost a week. Services of the Fort Smith and Western Railroad were discontinued in 1939. The road was abandoned and now a portion of the road bed is being